

Is ChatGPT's energy consumption justified?

Posted by u/Apprehensive-Basis70 • 0 points • 10 comments

Is the energy consumption of ChatGPT justified, considering the time it saves users compared to the additional time and energy spent completing tasks without it?

This is obviously a very nuanced topic and varies depending on how energy is sourced and how the application is used. I've seen a lot of testimonials on Reddit stating that it has halved their workload or more, and I'm a bit curious. What do you think?

Comments

u/scooby1st • 1 points • 2023-09-09 09:21 UTC

> Is the energy consumption of ChatGPT justified

Yes

>This is clearly a nuanced topic

No

u/Ok-Lobster-919 • 2 points • 2023-09-09 08:41 UTC

Infinitely more justifiable than blockchain power consumption.

u/Apprehensive-Basis70 • 1 points • 2023-09-09 08:42 UTC

Amen

u/davesmith001 • 1 points • 2023-09-09 08:10 UTC

Is the electricity you used to write this post justified? Is it justified the old lady keeps the heating on 30 degrees? It doesn't matter, it's not your place to care, all it matters is people want to use it and are willing to pay enough money to allow it to operate. This is how the economy works.

u/Apprehensive-Basis70 • 0 points • 2023-09-09 08:18 UTC

I'm curious about the numbers specifically, if you had read what I wrote you'd understand that I'm not pointing fingers and shaming anyone for it's use, nor am I asking for an explanation on how the economy works.

That's like someone asking how many calories a french fry has and you come along yelling at them because people love french fries and how dare you measure it!, you are not helpful.

u/davesmith001 • 1 points • 2023-09-09 08:23 UTC

Ok you can take that view but as an energy market professional I'm telling you that wondering if a specific use is grid positive or negative is usually a waste of time.

u/Apprehensive-Basis70 • 0 points • 2023-09-09 08:26 UTC

Well it's certainly my time to waste isn't it? As an energy market professional I'm glad you came to give a concise and intelligent response to a legitimate question instead of criticizing me for the high crime of...
...being curious...

u/davesmith001 • 2 points • 2023-09-09 08:59 UTC

Not everyone is capable of accepting criticism of their thought process. That's fine. What you are attempting to do is called counterfactual analysis, pretend if reality isn't so, and results are always directly determined by your own assumptions, which makes this a complete waste of time, but it is your time to waste.

A large part of academia on the hand is about concise thinking and avoiding nebulous ideas of dubious nature. Otherwise we'd spend all day wondering the infinite possibility of what might have been had I only not wrote a certain post. What good would that do honestly.

u/joeateworld • 1 points • 2023-09-09 07:34 UTC

Of course ChatGPT and other services. Use up a lot of energy. But the recent innovation in the open source, space shows that technology is coming that is much more energy efficient while maintaining similar capabilities. In a couple of years most of our every day tasks will probably be met by open-source local models. Until then I try to use GPT only in situations where I actually have huge time benefits. I also try to use GPT-4 only in situations where I need the improved capabilities. Summarization and other tasks are generally done pretty well by turbo.

u/zathruswriter • 4 points • 2023-09-09 06:59 UTC

There is plenty of energy sources - both renewable and not - all around the Earth and the Universe. It would be great if we could use the clean, renewable sources for things like robots and AI. Until that time, we'll use what we used for the past 150 years. But that one thing is a problem of our society, not AI or robots - because we are the ones to decide on how we power them.

That said - the one thing that's constant and non-renewable for us is **time**. So for me, if anything saves me time in this brutally sped-up society, so I can relax and enjoy my life on this planet, I'll say that its existence is 100% worth it.

u/Apprehensive-Basis70 • 2 points • 2023-09-09 07:02 UTC

I agree 1,000% with your perspective even if it's not quite the question that was posed. If I can save time and have a quality result I am all for it, especially since time is finite for us humans at the moment.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2023-09-09 05:54 UTC

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- * Discussion regarding positives and negatives about AI are allowed and encouraged. Just be respectful.
- * Please provide links to back up your arguments.
- * No stupid questions, unless its about AI being the beast who brings the end-times. It's not.

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